

PLAYING THE PART Napier Bridge wears a checkered look for the Chess Olympiad

ANI

and ranked on the Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR) for the past five years in each of the attributes. MDRA, a leading research agency, was engaged to collect the relevant data and determine the ranks for both the best performing and the most improved states. This was done by attaching a weightage to each category, with economy, infrastructure, agriculture, health and education being given more points (*see methodology*). This year, while Tamil Nadu has emerged as the best performing big state, Goa topped the small states. Likewise, Assam took the top honours among big states in the most improved category, and Manipur led the small states.

In order to make sure that Tamil Nadu maintains its top spot, Stalin has in the past 16 months struck a judicious balance between fostering economic growth and initiating a cluster of welfare schemes to help the needy. He has set up a high-powered economic advisory team that includes Nobel Laureate Esther Duflo and former RBI governor Raghuram Rajan to ensure balanced but rapid economic development across the state.

Meanwhile, Tamil Nadu has signed 207 MoUs through the various investment conclaves it has held, with the cumulative investment commitment amounting to Rs 2.23 lakh crore and projected employment opportunities for 344,150 people. These investments are expected to flow into fields as diverse as power plants, electronics, auto components, information technology, general manufacturing and pharmaceuticals. Currently a $300 billion (Rs 24,750 crore) economy, Tamil Nadu is aiming for double-digit growth every year to achieve three-fold growth by 2030. As part of a multi-pronged strategy, the state is working toward building world-class industrial and logistics infrastructure, developing the Chennai-Bengaluru and Chennai-Kanyakumari industrial corridors, focusing on sunrise sectors such as renewable energy and green hydrogen, and encouraging R&D, start-ups and a future-ready workforce.

TOP PERFORMERS IN BEST PERFORMING CATEGORY

RANK	STATE	APPEARANCES IN TOP 5* (2018-2022)
1	TAMIL NADU	49
2	KERALA	38
3	HIMACHAL PRADESH	33
4	GUJARAT	28
5	PUNJAB	27

*across the 12 categories

To encourage skill development, the DMK government has launched the 'Naan Mudhalvan (I am the first)' scheme to train a million youth to fill the current gaps in the industry. Already, more than 110,000 people have got jobs through the 1,027 micro and mega job fairs the government has hosted across the state. Five new industrial parks have also been set up; they are expected to provide employment to 22,000 people.

To promote research and development in the technology and fintech sectors and to attract global companies to set up business in the state, the Tamil Nadu FinTech Policy was launched in November 2021 and the Tamil Nadu Research and Development Policy in July 2022. The FinTech Policy, 2021, envisages the establishment of a FinTech City in Chennai, for which the Tamil Nadu Industrial Development Corporation (TIDCO) has earmarked 112 acres. Work has begun on its design and project management.

Since even best-laid plans can come undone by bureaucratic delays, Tamil Nadu is also working on improving ease of doing business (EODB). More than